

PARENT PLAYBOOK

How to raise a child who loves reading

Want to raise a child who loves reading? Bill Gates devoured books as a kid. Here's how to grow a reader - and why reading early shapes the brain, vocabulary, and success.

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The quick answer

Why is reading important for children? Reading builds vocabulary, strengthens the brain's language networks, grows empathy, and lays the foundation for success in every subject. Children who read - and are read to - early gain a head start that compounds for years. A reading habit is one of the most powerful advantages a child can have.

DO THIS

How to raise a child who loves reading

Work through these in order. Small, daily reps beat one big push.

1

Read aloud, every day

Even ten minutes of a shared book builds vocabulary and bonds. Make it cosy, not a chore.

2

Let them choose

A child who picks their own books - even 'silly' ones or comics - reads more. Interest beats 'good for you.'

3

Make books visible and screens less so

A bookshelf within reach, a book in the bag, a calmer bedtime without the screen.

4

Let them see YOU read

Kids copy what we do. A parent who reads for pleasure raises a child who reads for pleasure.

PARENT FAQ

Quick answers

How do I get my child to love reading?

Read aloud daily and make it cosy, let your child choose their own books (even comics), keep books visible and screens less so, and let them see you reading for pleasure. Joy and choice matter more than pressure - a child who links books with warmth will keep reaching for them.

Is it okay if my child only reads comics or 'silly' books?

Yes. Any reading the child enjoys builds vocabulary, fluency, and a love of books. Comics, joke books, and series count. Forcing 'proper' books can kill the habit; letting children read what they love keeps them reading - and their taste grows over time.

When should I start reading to my child?

From birth. Shared reading from infancy offers lifelong benefits, and brain studies link early home reading to stronger language development. You don't need them to understand every word - the sound of your voice, the closeness, and the words themselves are all building their brain.

My child prefers screens. How do I compete?

Don't fight screens head-on - make books easy and joyful instead. Keep books within reach, build a cosy daily read-aloud, protect a screen-free bedtime, and model reading yourself. When reading is warm and screens aren't the only option, children rediscover books.

Why does reading matter so much for success?

Reading builds vocabulary, strengthens the brain's language networks, grows empathy, and underpins learning in every subject. Children who read early gain an advantage that compounds for years, and the ability to teach themselves anything. It's one of the highest-return habits a child can have.

READING HELPS. PRACTICE STICKS.

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